Name Shortlist — Round 1

Europe → Gulf money-transfer app · Steps 2–5 · 10 Nov 2026 · Brief approved: **Certainty · Swiftness · Dignified care** — premium, trustworthy, Arabic-native

HOW WE GOT HERE

Stage	Count	What happened
Generated	~320	4 lanes: the real brief · "name the competitor" · diversion objects (carrier pigeon, hoopoe, falcon, envoy, caravan, navigation star) · Arabic/Latin roots & sound
Passed the gates	~30	No p/v dependence · no bad meaning in EU languages · no riba/gambling/religious misuse · not confusable with Gulf payment systems · store-ready
Knockout-searched	14	Web + app-store searches for live finance/payment brands (not register searches)
Shortlist	**8**	4 safe ↔ bold pairs, scored on the brief's scorecard (max 65)

STRONG NAMES WE CUT — AND WHY

Name	Reason
Fastran (yours)	One letter from **Fawran**, Qatar's national instant-payment system; "fast-" is descriptive.
Maalapp (yours)	*Mal* = "bad" in French/Spanish/Italian/Portuguese — your sending markets; Urdu/Hindi slang; "-app" restrictive.
Sila	Taken in payments: **Sila Money** (US money-movement API used for remittances) and **Sila Pay** (transfer app).
Wafi	**Wafi.cash** — a bank-payment processor based in Dublin (your sending side); Saudi "Waffy" also exists.
Barq · Sadeed · Mada-alikes	**Barq** is a Saudi transfer fintech; Sadeed sounds like **SADAD** (Saudi bill-payment system).
Thiqa · Daman · Amana · Amin	Thiqa = Abu Dhabi health programme / Saudi Thiqah; Daman = UAE insurer; Amana & Amin crowded in Gulf finance.
Yaqin · Tasleem · Burak	Religious meanings a payments product could be seen to trivialise.
Barid · Jisr · Zajil · Sahm	Barid also means "cold"; Jisr (Saudi HR app); Zajil (Saudi courier); Sahm (Saudi brokerage).

THE SHORTLIST — 4 SAFE ↔ BOLD PAIRS

Pair 1 · The envoy (evocative)

SAFE

Safir سفير

"Ambassador / envoy." Your money travels with an ambassador — someone who is trusted, represents you with dignity, and always arrives. Reads as *saphir* (sapphire) to French ears: premium.

👝 **Safir: Send Money to the Gulf** (29)
🗣️ "I sent it with Safir — it's already there."
🔔 "Your 500 € has arrived in Riyadh. — Safir"

57/65 fit 4 · distinct 4 · sound 5 · memo 5 · grow 5 · practical 3

Flags: Safir hotels (Kuwait) & a Turkish shopping app exist — different classes; safir.com taken → getsafir.com / safir.app.

BOLD

Hudhud هدهد

The hoopoe — the messenger bird that carried King Sulaiman's letter across kingdoms. Every Arabic speaker knows the story: a small, swift messenger that delivers what matters. Unforgettable, ownable, a ready-made mascot and icon.

👝 **Hudhud: Send Money to the Gulf** (30)
🗣️ "Just Hudhud it to my mother."
🔔 "Hudhud delivered: 2,031 SAR to Mama."

49/65 fit 3 · distinct 5 · sound 3 · memo 4 · grow 4 · practical 4

Flags: may read playful rather than premium — identity must do the elevating; Quranic story association → native-speaker check; hudhud.com "maybe free".

Pair 2 · Certainty

SAFE

Certa

Latin root of "certain." Instantly understood in English, French (*certes*), Italian, Spanish (*cierta*) — the sending side — and easy for Arabic speakers. Says the #1 association directly, with a premium Latin finish.

👝 **Certa: Send Money to the Gulf** (29)
🗣️ "Use Certa — you always know it got there."
🔔 "Certa: delivered and confirmed ✓"

54/65 fit 5 · distinct 3 · sound 5 · memo 4 · grow 5 · practical 2

Flags: "Certa-" prefix used by non-finance brands (e.g. CertaPro) — check class 36; spelled C or S when heard; certa.com taken.

BOLD

Akeed أكيد

"Definitely! / For sure!" — the word Gulf and Levant speakers say every day. Certainty in their own warm voice: the reassuring answer to "Will it arrive?" Instantly memorable, culturally native, no translation needed.

👝 **Akeed: Send Money to the Gulf** (29)
🗣️ "Did it arrive? — Akeed."
🔔 "Akeed ✓ 2,031 SAR received by Ahmed."

51/65 fit 5 · distinct 3 · sound 4 · memo 4 · grow 4 · practical 3

Flags: **Akeed** is an Omani food-delivery app (owned by Snoonu) — different class, but same region; colloquial tone needs premium identity.

Pair 3 · Arrival & connection

SAFE

Wasla وصلة

"The link" — from *w-ṣ-l*, the root of arriving (*waṣal* = "it arrived!") and of family ties. One word that holds both certainty of arrival and the bond with family at home.

🦺 **Wasla: Send Money to the Gulf** (29)
🗣️ "Wasla? Wasal — it arrived."
🔔 "Wasal ✓ Your transfer has arrived."

49/65 fit 4 · distinct 3 · sound 4 · memo 4 · grow 5 · practical 3
Flags: **Wasl** (Azm) is a SAMA-licensed financing broker in Saudi — confusion risk in class 36; Wasl Properties (Dubai).

BOLD

Qasid قاصد

The classical Arabic courier — the trusted messenger sent on purpose to a specific person. Also carries *qaṣd*, "intent": money sent with purpose. Literary, dignified, rare in fintech.

🦺 **Qasid: Send Money to the Gulf** (29)
🗣️ "Send it with Qasid."
🔔 "Qasid has delivered your transfer."

44/65 fit 4 · distinct 4 · sound 2 · memo 3 · grow 4 · practical 4
Flags: Europeans will say "Kassid", the "q" looks foreign; weakest on sound.

Pair 4 · English promise ↔ Arabic sender

SAFE

Surely

A real English word that *is* the promise: "surely it arrives." Calm, confident, instantly understood across Europe; Arabic speakers pronounce it easily.

🦺 **Surely: Send Money to the Gulf** (30)
🗣️ "Send it Surely."
🔔 "Surely delivered ✓"

48/65 fit 5 · distinct 2 · sound 4 · memo 5 · grow 4 · practical 1
Flags: common word → weak trademark, hard to own handles/domains; English-only charm.

BOLD

Rasil راسل

"Correspond / send" — from the root of *risāla*, a letter sent with care. Short, rare as a brand, sounds clean in Arabic and European languages alike.

🦺 **Rasil: Send Money to the Gulf** (29)
🗣️ "Rasil it to Dubai."
🔔 "Rasil: your money is on its way — ETA 3 min."

50/65 fit 4 · distinct 4 · sound 4 · memo 3 · grow 4 · practical 4
Flags: meaning less obvious to non-Arabic users; story needs telling.

HOW TO DECIDE (THE LEXICON WAY)

- **First ask "what could this name do for us?"** — before anyone criticises. (Safir → an "ambassador" service tier; Akeed → every confirmation screen says the brand.)
- **Competitor test:** "Careem Pay just launched a transfer product called ___ ." Which one makes you uncomfortable? That's a strong one.
- **A split reaction is a good sign.** Intel's room split on Pentium. Unanimous comfort usually means tame.
- **If you test with users, test belief and pronunciation — never "which do you like?"** Ask Arabic speakers in Europe: "Would you trust an app called ___ to send 1,000 € to your family?" and "Say it / spell it after hearing it once."

MY RECOMMENDATION

Safir leads on the scorecard (57) — premium, effortless in Arabic *and* European languages, and it carries all three associations. **Akeed** is the bold pick with the most emotional pull for a *worried* sender. If you feel a pull between those two, that split is useful: it's the choice between "dignified premium" and "warm certainty."

NEXT

Reply with your reactions (love / maybe / no for each, and why). I'll run Round 2 in the direction you like, then take 1–3 finalists into **validation**: EUIPO / UK IPO / UAE / SAIP (Saudi) / WIPO knockouts in Nice classes **36** (money transfer) + **9** (app) + **42** (platform), native-speaker checks (Gulf Arabic, Levantine, Maghrebi + French/German/Spanish/Italian), domains & handles, then attorney clearance.

Knockout screen only — web and app-store searches on 10 Nov 2026, not trademark-register searches or legal advice. ".com taken?" means the domain resolves in DNS. Scores use the scorecard in the approved brief (weights 3·3·3·2·1·1, max 65), computed with code. Longlist (~320) and score sheet kept in *longlist_internal.md* and *scores.csv*.